

ALCHEMY OF FAITH

When creativity isn't bound by tradition, the past finds its future

By **RIDHI KALE**

Storytelling with metal isn't new, but the way Ashiesh Shah treats it, the material becomes something scared, spiritual even. Born from his time at the Kumbh, the collection represents a two-year pilgrimage to the sweet spot where art, craft and faith meet with flair. The fitting backdrop for the collection, called Taamr, was the India Art Fair 2026; where you'll recognise ritualistic forms such as the *matka, urli* and *lingam*, but they've been cheekily repositioned alongside stone and metal. That said, these pieces aren't frozen in time. The copper surfaces are engineered to evolve, deepening in character (and patina) as they age. Taamr is a brilliant, shimmering ode to history, but with a serious glow-up.

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